E-Collar
TRAINING GUIDE

A Practical Guide to E-Collar Training
for the Everyday Pet Dog



Ryan R. McKenzie

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This book offers general training information for pet owners. It is not a substitute for advice from your veterinarian or a qualified trainer who can see your dog. Use any training tool according to its maker's instructions.

First edition, 2026

Before We Begin

This book picks up where our free guide, E-Collar Introduction, leaves off. If your dog lights up when the collar comes out, wears it like any other collar, and turns to you happily when it feels the touch, you are in the right place. If not, go back and finish that guide first. Everything in here is built on it.

Here is what this book is for. The e-collar is an advanced tool. Used the right way, it gives your dog more freedom and a clearer way to understand you. Used the wrong way, it can set your dog's training back or hurt the dog. We wrote this book to help you use it properly, and to keep you from making the mistakes that are easy to make when nobody walks you through the order. Most people who pick up an e-collar want the same thing. They want a dog they can trust off the leash. They want a walk where the leash is slack, a dog that comes the first time it is called, and a dog that settles on its bed when the doorbell rings. That is what we are going to build, one small step at a time.

This is a how-to book. It is written for the everyday pet owner, not the professional trainer and not the sport competitor. We kept it simple on purpose. Every chapter has the same shape: what we are working on, the steps, the mistakes we see most, and how to know when you are ready to move on. Read a chapter, go practise it, and come back when your dog is ready. Go by your dog, not the calendar.



How we think about the e-collar

We think of the e-collar as a wireless leash. Everything it does, it does because your dog first learned it on a real leash. A leash lets you guide your dog with light pressure, and your dog learns to switch that pressure off by moving the right way. The e-collar does the same job, without the line between you. That is all it is.

The collar never teaches anything new. We teach every behavior first with food, then with words, then with lots of repetition. Only when a dog really knows a behavior do we lay the collar over the top of it. If you remember one thing from this book, remember that.

Our order, start to finish

Every behavior in this book goes through the same order. You will see it again and again.

1. **Lure and shape with food.** We use food to guide the dog into the position and our marker to tell it the instant it got it right. As the dog understands, we fade the lure.

2. **Add the word.** Once the dog will do it reliably without the lure, we name it.
3. **Repetitions.** Lots of them, in short, happy sessions.
4. **Proofing.** We add duration and distraction, a little at a time.

Leash pressure is taught on its own, away from those happy food sessions, so pressure never sours your dog's motivation. The e-collar is layered on top of known behaviors, using the same pressure and release your dog learned on the leash. Corrections, if they are ever needed, come last, and only on behaviors your dog knows fluently.

Food does not stay forever. We fade it to a random schedule, then swap much of it for toys and play: tugs, wedges, balls, a flirt pole with a rag or a piece of leather. By the end, your dog works for the game, the praise and the freedom.

A word on the law

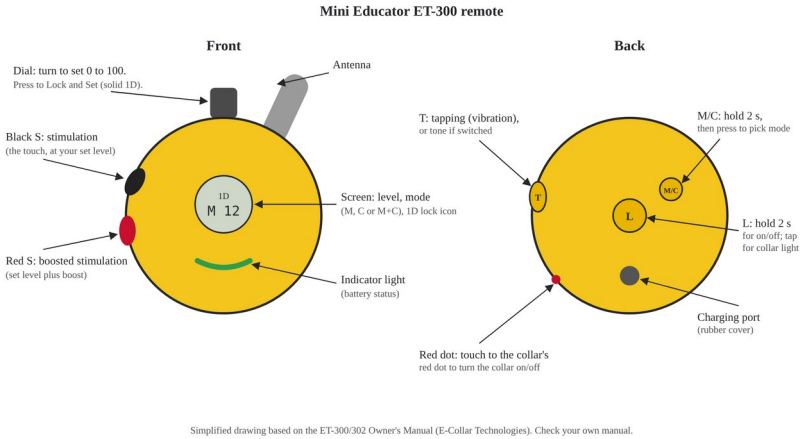
Some places have banned or restricted the e-collar. We think those bans are unfair to the dogs. Used the way this book teaches, the e-collar gives a dog a kind, clear path to more freedom, and taking that away leaves many dogs on a leash for life. That said, the law is the law. Before you start, check your local laws on e-collar use, and check the leash rules wherever you walk. Off leash means only where it is allowed.

What you need

- A Mini Educator ET-300, conditioned as in E-Collar Introduction.
- Your dog's flat collar or harness and a regular leash.
- A long line, about 10 to 15 metres, and a lighter drag line for later.
- A place mat or raised bed.
- Small, soft treats your dog loves, and one or two favourite toys.

- A notebook, or the logs at the back of this book.
- Ten to fifteen minutes, once or twice a day.

Chapter 1: Your Mini Educator



Simplified drawing based on the ET-300/302 Owner's Manual (E-Collar Technologies). Check your own manual.

Why this one

We have tried a lot of collars over the years. The Mini Educator ET-300 from E-Collar Technologies is the one we put on our own dogs, and it is the one this whole book is written around. Here is why.

- **Fine steps.** The dial runs from 0 to 100. That means you can find the faintest level your dog can feel and move one small step at a time. Fewer steps on a dial means bigger jumps between them, and big jumps are what startle dogs.
- **A softer feel.** It uses what the maker calls blunt stimulation. It feels more like a muscle tap than a sharp sting. Hold it in your hand and you will understand.
- **Choices.** It has the touch, a tapping vibration on its own button, and an adjustable boost. You will use the touch almost all the time.
- **Built for real life.** It is fully waterproof and reaches about half a mile. Rain, snow, ponds and the beach are all fine.

End of the free preview.

The full book, E-Collar Training Guide, is by Ryan R. McKenzie.